MIL-R-82404A(CG)
20 June 1969
SUPERSEDING
MIL-R-82404
6 March 1966

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

RIBBON, SERVICE CAP (BAND)

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope.- This specification covers requirements for the ribbons to be used as bands on caps worn by Coast Guard enlisted personnel.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids form a part of this specification.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft Wrapping.
CCC-T-191 - Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Fiber.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.
PPP-T- 60 - Tape; Pressure Sensitive Adhesive, Waterproof, For Packaging and Sealing.

FSC 8455

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes and appendix thereto.

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

2.2 Other publications.- The following document forms a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Standard Color Card of America

(Copies should be obtained from the Color Card Association of the United States, Inc., 200 Madison Avenue, New York, New York 10016).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Sample.- Samples are furnished as a guide only. Variations from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern. Except for such variations, the design, quality and workmanship, in all respects not covered by this specification, shall be equal to the sample (see 6.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2 Preproduction sample approval.- Unless otherwise specified, before production is commenced, the contractor shall submit for approval to the contracting officer, a finished ribbon conforming to the requirements of design, construction, and workmanship of this specification (see 6.2).

3.3 Material

3.3.1 Yarn.- The yarns shall be first quality, continuous filament, free from any adulterants or weighting material and shall conform to requirements specified in 3.3.1.1 and 3.3.1.2.

3.3.1.1 Ground yarn.- The warp, selvage and filling yarns shall be solution - dyed rayon, 100 denier with a minimum of 25 filaments, 12 to 18 turns per inch, "S" twist and solution-dyed black to match Cable No. 65018 of the Standard Color Card of America.

3.3.1.2. Legend yarn.- The filling yarn for legend shall be bright rayon, 200 denier with a minimum of 40 filaments, 2 to 5 turns per inch, "S" or "Z" twist and vat-dyed gold to match Cable No. 70157 of the Standard Color Card of America.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4 Construction

3.4.1 Weave

3.4.1.1 Ground weave.- The ground weave shall be a plain weave and shall contain, when finished, 180 ends per inch and a minimum of 74 picks per inch. The selvages shall be double plain weave with a minimum of 6 double ends in each selvage.

3.4.1.2 Legend weave.- The legend weave shall be interwoven into the ground weave with a 12-end filling satin weave, using a counter of 7. The legend shall be constructed with not less than a total of 392 picks.

3.4.2 Width.- The width shall be 1-1/2 (± 1/16) inches, including selvages.

3.4.3. Length.- The ribbon shall be not less than 27 inches long. Each ribbon shall be straight cut with ends perpendicular to the selvage edge.

3.4.4 Legend.- The legend "U. S. COAST GUARD" shall be in gold colored block letters 1/2 (± 1/16) inch high. The left edge of the letter "U" shall measure 1⅞ (± 1/16) inches from the left end of the finished ribbon. The right edge of the letter

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

"D" shall measure 24-1/8 (± 1/16) inches from the left end of the finished ribbon. The top and bottom edges of the lettering shall measure 1/2 (± 1/16) inch from either edge of the selvage. (see figure 1).

3.4.4.1 Figure.- The figure is furnished for information purposes only. To the extent of inconsistencies between this specification and the figure, the specification shall govern.

3.5 Colorfastness.- The ribbons shall show fastness to crocking, salt water, perspiration, wet dry cleaning and light equal to or better than the sample of reference when tested as specified in 4.4. When no sample or reference is available, the ribbon shall show good fastness to crocking, salt water, perspiration, wet dry cleaning and light when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.6 Workmanship.- The quality of manufacture shall be controlled to guarantee conformity with the standard of workmanship established in this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 General.- The quality assurance provisions contained in this specification are applicable to inspection

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Quality assurance provisions for components or materials described shall be in accordance with this specification and with subsidiary specifications referenced herein to the extent applicable, except that this specification shall govern in event of conflict.

4.1.1 Contractor's inspection responsibility.- Unless otherwise specified herein, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements prior to submission for Government inspection and acceptance. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any other commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order.

4.2 Pre-acceptance inspection

4.2.1 Preproduction inspection.- When required, inspection and testing of the preproduction sample shall be performed by the Government. Finished ribbons shall be inspected for compliance with requirements of design, construction, finish and workmanship.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance.- Determination of acceptability of the end item with regard to inspection required herein, shall be in accordance with the provisions of Standard MIL-STD-105 and appendix.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.1 Inspection of components.- The yarn shall be inspected as shown in Table I. The unit of product shall be one cone or spool of each denier and color specified. For each characteristic listed in Table I, the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 test failures per hundred units and the inspection level shall be L-1, Table VII of appendix to Standard MIL-STD-105.

Table I.- Inspection of components

Characteristics	Paragraph Requirement	Test Method	Results Reported As	Sample Unit
Color				
Black	3.3.1.1	Visual	pass or fail	1
Gold	3.3.1.2	Visual	pass or fail	1
Material identification				
Black	3.3.1.1	1500	pass or fail	1
		or 1510	pass or fail	1
Gold	3.3.1.2	1500	pass or fail	1
Denier 1/				
Black	3.3.1.1	4010	nearest whole number	5
Gold	3.3.1.2	4010	nearest whole number	5
Filament Count (Min)				
Black	3.3.1.1	Visual	nearest whole number	2
Gold	3.3.1.2	Visual	nearest whole number	2
Twist				
Black	3.3.1.1	4050	pass or fail	1
Gold	3.3.1.2	4050	pass or fail	1
Turns per inch				
Black	3.3.1.1	4052	nearest whole number	20
Gold	3.3.1.2	4052	nearest whole number	20

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

1/ Denier shall be calculated as follows:

$$\text{Denier} = \frac{\text{weight of specimen in grams} \times 9000}{\text{length of specimen in meters}}$$

4.3.2 Inspection of end item.- The ribbon shall be inspected to determine conformance with the requirements of this specification. Defects found during this inspection shall be classified in accordance with the list shown herein.

4.3.2.1 The defects listed in 4.3.2.1.1 shall be counted regardless of their proximity to each other, except where two or more defects represent a single condition of the ribbon, in which case only the more serious defect shall be counted. The unit of product shall be one ribbon. The Government reserves the right to classify as a defect any departure from this specification not specifically listed (see 4.3.2.1.1).

4.3.2.1.1 Classification of defects

ATTRIBUTES EXAMINED	DEFECT
Material defects	Manufacturing defects such as holes, floats, broken threads, slugs, slough-offs, streaks or other clearly noticeable affecting serviceability or appearance.
Workmanship defects	Cut, tear, or abrasion.
	Noticeable mend or repair.
	Noticeable spots or stains.
Design (Legend)	Any detail not conforming to item sample.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

ATTRIBUTES EXAMINED	DEFECTS
Design (Legend)	Lettering not gold. Background not black.
	Mis-shaped or distorted design, affecting appearance.
Edges	Cut, torn, or broken selvage edge.
	Loopy or stringy selvage edge.
	Edges not straight.
Shade	Noticeably off shade.

4.3.2.1.1.1 Dimensional inspection.- The unit of product for this inspection shall be one ribbon.

MEASURE	DEFECTS	
	less than	more than
Width of ribbon	1-7/16	1-9/16
Lettering from either edge of the selvage	7/16	9/16
Left edge of the letter "U" from from the left end of the finished ribbon.	17-15/16	18-1/16
Right edge of the letter "D" from the left end of the finished ribbon.	24-1/16	24-3/16

NOTE: All measurements are expressed in inches.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.3 Acceptable quality levels and inspection levels.- The acceptable quality levels and inspection levels shall be as follows:

Visual Inspection----------1.5 defects per hundred units.

Inspection Level II.
Dimensional Inspection----------2.5 defects per hundred units.

Inspection Level L-8

4.4 Tests.- The finished ribbon shall be tested as indicated in Table II. For each characteristic, the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 test failures per hundred units and the inspection level shall be L-1, Table VII of appendix to Standard MIL-STD-105. The unit of product, the sample unit for test, shall be 8 finished ribbons from the lot. Tests shall be conducted in accordance with the methods prescribed in specification CCC-T-191 and supplementary specifications listed in 2.1 and as specified in Table II.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. - TESTS

Characteristics	Requirement paragraph	Method	Reported as
Weave			
Ground	3.4.1.1	Visual	pass or fail
Selvage	3.4.1.1	Visual	pass or fail
Legend	3.4.1.2	Visual	pass or fail
Count			
Ground	3.4.1.1	5050	Nearest whole number
Selvage	3.4.1.1	5050	Nearest whole number
Legend	3.4.1.2	5050	Nearest whole number
Colorfastness to:			
Wet dry cleaning	3.5	5622	good, fair or poor
Salt water	3.5	5632	good, fair or poor
Crocking 1/	3.5	5651	good, fair or poor
Light 2/	3.5	5660	good, fair or poor
Perspiration 3/	3.5	5680	good, fair or poor

1/ Delete MUNSELL value "3.5" and substitute MUNSELL value "8.5."

2/ The ribbon shall be exposed for 40 hours.

3/ The transfer cloth shall consist of a warp of orlon - 81 and a 6-fiber filling of equal bars of wool, spun nylon, spun rayon, spun silk, spun acetate and bleached cotton. Each 6-fiber repeat shall measure approximately 2 inches and shall be separated by a waste filling stripe.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.1. Level A

5.1.1.1. Cap ribbon band with legend.

5.1.1.1.1 UNIT PACKAGE- Ten each ribbon bands to be packaged in a flat, unfolded manner in a paper wrapper properly secured to contain contents.

5.1.1.1.2 INTERMEDIATE PACKAGE - Ten (10) unit packages (100 cap ribbon bands) to be placed between two pieces of cardboard in a flat, unfolded manner properly secured to contain contents.

5.1.2 Level C - Ribbons shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's normal practice.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.- Twelve domestic shipping containers of cap bands, packed as specified in 5.2.2.1, shall be over-packed six in length, one in width, and two in depth within an export shipping container conforming to the requirements of type I or II, class 2, grade 3, style FOL of specification PPP-B-636. The inside dimensions of the export shipping container shall be 46-3/4 inches in length, 16-1/4 inches in width, and 24 inches in depth. The requirements for closure and strapping of the boxes shall conform to the Appendix of Specification PPP-B-636, except that the container flaps shall be glued (not stitched), and the boxes strapped with flat steel straps only. In addition, all corners and joints of the boxes shall be sealed by the application of a 3-inch width cloth tape conforming to the requirements of type II class 1, olive drab color of Specification PPP-T-60.

5.2.2 Level B.-

5.2.2.1 Packing method.- Sixteen hundred (1600) cap ribbon bands packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be packed in a domestic shipping container, as follows: Step 1. Bottom layer.-

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Place 8 packages of 100 ribbons each, on side edge, with the length of the packages parallel to the end panels of the container. Step 2. Top layer.- Repeat step 1 to complete the pack. The domestic fiberboard shipping container shall conform to the requirements outlined in 5.2.2.1.1.

5.2.2.1.1 Shipping container.- The domestic fiberboard shipping container, for cap ribbon bands, shall conform to the requirements of type I, class 1, style CSSC of Specification PPP-B-636, except that the manufacturer's joint shall be stitched only. The fiberboard shall be fabricated from B-flute corrugated medium, with a minimum bursting strength of 350 psi. The inside dimensions of the shipping container shall be 15-1/2 inches in length, 11-9/16 inches in width, and 7-1/8 inches in depth.

5.2.2.1.2 Closure.- All flaps of the domestic fiberboard shipping container shall be sealed with an adhesive (glue), used commercially for fiberboard containers, by application throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps; or by a combination of metal stitching the bottom flaps and sealing the top flaps with an adhesive (glue).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.3 Level C.- Ribbons packaged as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in a manner which will insure acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Shipping containers shall conform to the Consolidated Freight Classification Regulations or to regulations of other carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking

5.3.1 Normal marking.- Set-up boxes or folding cartons and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-129.

5.3.2 Special marking.- The following information shall be legibly printed, stencilled or stamped on the open-end paper wrapper specified in 5.1.1.1.1:

10 each Ribbon, Band
U. S. COAST GUARD
Name of contractor
Date and number of contract
Number of this specification
Stock number
Contracting Office

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- Ribbons covered by this specification are intended for use as cap bands.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(a) Title, number and date of this specification

(b) Availability of sample (see 3.1 and 6.3)

(c) Requirements for preproduction sample (see 3.2)

(d) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2)

NOTICE. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

Preparing Activity:

U. S. Coast Guard

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

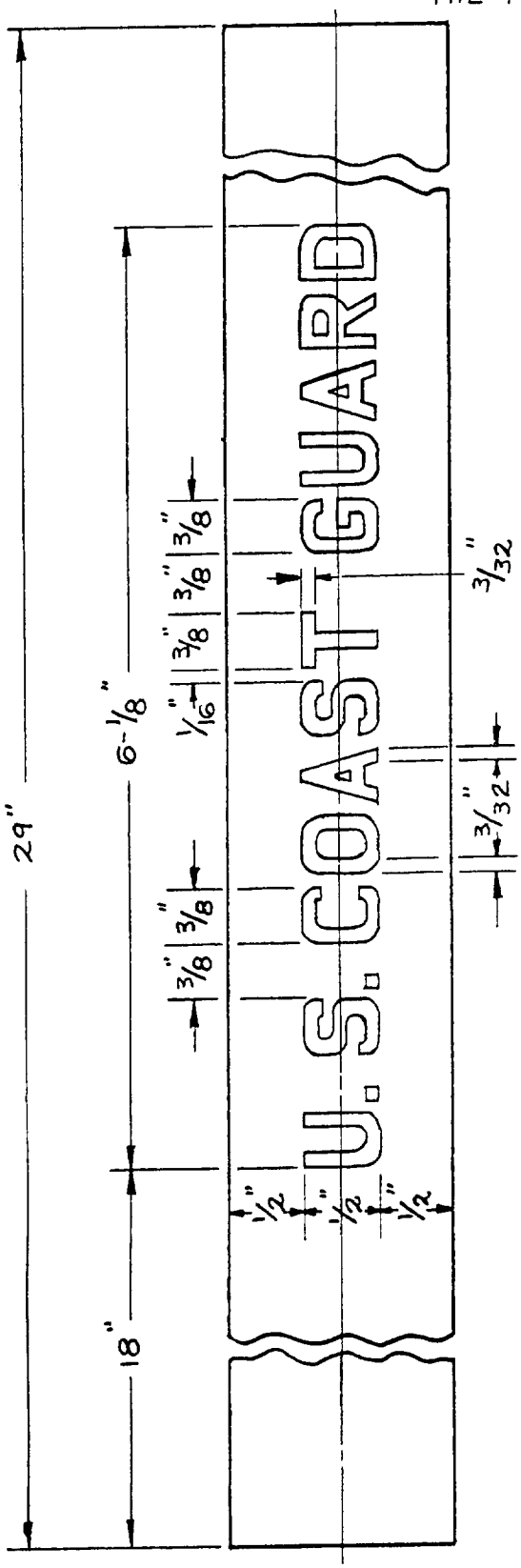


FIGURE 1 - Ribbon, Service Cap (Band)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-23T07:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.